

First-Generation Student Alliance Constitution

2024-2025

Article I: Name

The formal name of this organization shall be First Generation Student Alliance (FGSA).

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of the First-Generation Student Alliance (FGSA) shall be to help other first-generation students to find community, offer learning opportunities about Furman resources/opportunities, assist when able with University first-generation student initiatives, and participate in other opportunities as they are presented.us

Furman applies the most commonly accepted definition of “first-generation student,” which is that neither parent/guardian completed a four-year degree.

The First-Generation Student Alliance (FGSA) is an inclusive, community-building organization whose purpose is to provide welcoming spaces for first-generation students on campus at Furman University to fellowship, offer learning resources to increase accessibility, and amplify the voice of first-generation students through student initiatives and engagement.

Article III: Affiliations

FGSA is affiliated with offices within both Student Life and Academic Affairs who oversee the University's first-generation student initiatives.

Article IV: Membership

In keeping with Furman University's nons-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, and graduate students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, geographic origin, socioeconomic background, disability, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Membership is open to all first-generation students at Furman University, and all FGSA students will receive cords for graduation Senior Year, by the University. Additionally, all Seniors who are actively participating in FGSA initiatives and have accrued 4 points per semester, shall be rewarded with a Senior Gift at our yearly banquet.

FGSA will hold monthly initiatives or events per academic year that count toward the status of active membership.

To be considered a voting member, a student must be enrolled in our Syncedin.. The requirements of FGSA's point system are subject to being changed by the current executive board as needed. In addition to voting rights, First-Generation members are eligible to run for officer positions, be a part of FGSA communications and First Gen student initiatives on campus by administration, may attend any events/programs offered by FGSA and are eligible to receive merchandise.

Article V: Officers

To qualify to hold office, the individual must be a first-generation student as defined above under Article II: Purpose (Furman applies the most commonly accepted definition of “first-generation student,” which is that neither parent/guardian completed a four-year degree.) . Additionally, the individual must be a member as defined under Article IV: Membership. Individuals hold office from one academic year. Elections will occur in March or April of each year. If a position becomes absent, a popular vote of the membership will fill that position until the upcoming March elections.

1. President. The president's responsibilities include attending and leading all meetings (both executive board and general body meetings), representing the organization at events and national conferences, advocating for First generation Students to University Faculty and Staff, and assisting the other positions as necessary.
2. Vice-President. The vice president's responsibilities include assisting the president by serving in place of the president when unavailable (I.E: Stand in for when the president cannot make it, help make decisions with the executive team, assist in the planning & running of meetings, etc.) lead and review the constitution and bylaws at the beginning of each year, work alongside the executive board to create and order the apparel and merchandise for club (such as T-shirts, buttons, stickers, etc in which T-shirts need to be ordered in the beginning of Fall term), and give a speech at the First generation Luncheon held by the University in August.
3. Treasurer. The treasurer's responsibilities include reporting to SDC expenditures and requesting funding, building as well as reporting a budget, reconciling expenses with the University, submitting budget requests in a timely manner, ensure all services used are rightfully paid, checking out as well as being responsible for the SDC credit card when needed, and adhering to the SDC financial bylaws, Work with all members on the executive team to be sure that the amount of funding remaining after events is clear, answering questions about the budget to other executive members as it can be confusing to those outside of this position, and ensure our spending matches our approved budget.
4. Secretary. The secretary's responsibilities include taking attendance, taking notes of all meetings, running all social media, helping move our resources from our Gmail to Syncedin, keeping track of points/attendance, and maintaining/ updating a roster of active members.

The positions above (Executives) are determined by the popular vote of the membership. Any additional positions needed for the functioning of FGSA will be appointed by the Executives by

$\frac{3}{4}$ vote. An Executive may be removed by a $\frac{2}{3}$ vote of the membership after consultation with the FGSA advisor.

Article VI: Advisor

FGSA's advisors provide guidance and mentorship to officers as well as assist with any disciplinary matters of members. FGSA's advisors complete all necessary University paperwork required by SDC or the Office of Student Involvement & Inclusion.

Article VII: Meetings

FGSA holds monthly events per academic year that count toward attendance. The Executive board may plan additional meetings and events as needed by the general body, and have the discretion to decide which events and meetings will be offered within each month. The final meeting in the spring semester prior to our banquet will include end-of-the-year elections.

Article VIII: Finance

FGSA is funded by SDC. Additional funds may be provided by the University as it relates to University first-generation initiatives.

Article IX: Amendments

Approval from most of the executive board is required to make amendments to this constitution, usually including approval from the President, Vice President, and or Secretary.